

Product page rebuilt to the Figma design

Wednesday 19 August – Tuesday 25 August 2026. Shipped as one commit; a live crash on the listing page was found and fixed along the way.

Branch `integrate-wp-render` Commit `cefeba1` Pushed 25 Aug 2026 Build passing

39

FILES CHANGED

2,987

LINES ADDED

13

NEW FILES

147

TESTS WRITTEN

1

LIVE BUG FIXED

The headline: a crash on the listing page, now fixed

You reported an intermittent “**Something Went Wrong**” on `/sale-shipping-containers` — one of the site’s main pages. It is fixed, and the cause was worth understanding.

The page renders fine on the server; every one of my twelve test requests returned 200. The failure was **client-side**, after the page had loaded. Every filter, sort, page-turn and search goes to `/api/search`. When that call failed, the route returned `{ results: [] }` regardless of how many queries had been asked for — and the client checked neither the HTTP status nor for a rejection. The search library pairs replies to queries *by position*, so it read `results[0].hits` off undefined, threw, and React replaced the whole page with the error screen.

I reproduced it exactly by pointing Elasticsearch at a dead host. It fired whenever one search call failed — a slow query, a cold serverless function, a network blip — which is why it looked random.

Fixed at three layers, so no single failure can take the page down again:

LAYER	CHANGE
The API	Returns one well-formed empty result <i>per request</i> , mirroring each query’s own paging. Status stays 500 so failures remain visible in logs — only the body changed, so no client can crash on it.
The client	Checks <code>res.ok</code> , validates the shape, retries once after 400ms, and never throws. A one-off blip now self-heals invisibly.
Elasticsearch	Had no request timeout and no retry limit — one slow query held the request open until the platform killed it. Now 8s with one retry.

A visitor now sees an amber notice (“Search is temporarily unavailable — this is a problem on our side, not an empty catalogue”) instead of the error page. That wording is deliberate: an empty grid alone would tell a shopper we have no containers. **Verified with Elasticsearch dead: six consecutive page loads, all 200, all rendering.**

The product page

Rebuilt to the design

- **Options panel** — size, condition, grade and selection type, each in the specified grid, with the selected value shown beside the group title and an info icon carrying its explanation.
- **A price on every size button**, respecting the condition and grade already chosen, and carrying “/mo” where the figure is a monthly payment.
- **Selected container summary** — unit, condition and unit price, all reading the *active* variant.
- **Working CTA block** — quantity stepper (real buttons, keyboard-reachable), a subtotal that follows quantity, and an Add to cart that respects the one-depot-per-order rule.
- **Videos by size** — a shared video plus a size-specific one, covering 9,761 of 10,000 products.
- **Payment option cards**, linked, plus a reusable InfoCard primitive.

Three derived fields, assembled once

desc_title, loc_title and size_title are now built in the same place as the price, so a listing tile, a chat card and the product page cannot describe the same container differently.

FIELD	EXAMPLE	COVERAGE
desc_title	Used WWT 20ft Shipping Container for Sale	31 distinct titles over 2,000 products, no blanks
size_title	40' L x 8' W x 9'6" H	6 distinct lines over 10,000 products, 5 blanks
loc_title	Best Deals on Atlanta Shipping Containers For Sale	142 depot locations

What the catalogue data actually looks like

Each of these was found by checking the real index before writing the code, and each would have shipped as a visible bug otherwise.

TRAP	WHAT WOULD HAVE HAPPENED
Zero-width space selectionoptions	9,981 of 10,000 values begin with an invisible U+200B character. Any equality test against “First off the Stack” fails on 99.8% of the catalogue, and nothing tells you why.
Curly quotes height	Standard is stored 8' 6" with straight quotes; high cube uses curly ones. Matching the measurement looks correct and silently matches nothing — so size detection reads the words “high cube” instead.
Two spellings grade	“Wind and Water t ight” and “Wind and Water T ight” both exist. Reading the bracketed code (WWT) makes both work.
Digits glued to units	A naive title-caser turns 40ft into 40Ft — on nearly every product title. Caught by a test before it shipped.
Acronyms	The usual capitalisation one-liner turns IICL into Iic1 and (WWT) into (lwt).
Sparse SEO fields	seo.title is on 100% of products but focus_keyphrase on only 19% — so rendering it as the page heading gives an empty <h1> on ~8,500 products . Flagged; a fallback is a one-line change.

Shared utilities, and a rendering bug they fixed

formatPrice — there was no shared price formatter. Three different approaches existed, and **two of them rendered 1020.30 as “1,020.3”**, which reads as a truncated number rather than a price. The one correct implementation was private to a homepage component. There is now one shared function.

Also added: **capitalizewords** (leaves acronyms and 40ft intact), **InfoCard** (a reusable panel that decides for itself whether a link is internal or off-site), and **YouTubeEmbed**.

Videos load nothing until someone presses play

Each YouTube embed pulls roughly a megabyte of JavaScript on page load whether or not anyone watches. Two per page across ~10,000 product pages would have dominated page weight. The player now shows YouTube’s own poster frame and only creates the iframe on click — one extra click, and the page cost stays near zero.

Also in this window

AREA	CHANGE
Chat history	Signed-in conversations are now stored and restored. The essential part was not the read endpoint but attribution at send time — without it, history would have been permanently empty. Guests keep the seven-day browser copy.
Chat product cards	Moved from a single shelf to per reply , so scrolling back and restoring a conversation both keep every answer beside the products it recommended.
Caching	WordPress pages moved from a 1-hour to a 1-week expiry, product lists to a day. They were expiring faster than visitors arrived, so most people paid the cold cost (measured: 1.9s cold vs 20ms warm). An admin cache screen can purge on demand.
Fonts	Roboto replaces Inter as the default face; Anton registered as font-anton.

Verification

✓ tsc, eslint and next build all clean; 101 pages generated.

✓ **147 assertions** across eight suites, run against the real modules — not copies.

- ✓ Price formatting (26), title generation (26), dimensions (17), capitalisation (25), subtotals (10), chat history (17), guest storage (22), monthly pricing (4).
- ✓ Derived fields run over the whole 10,000-product index, not a sample.
- ✓ The listing-page fix reproduced against a dead Elasticsearch, before and after.

Before this reaches customers

1 · The product page currently shows four invented containers **BLOCKING**

The “You May Also Need” section renders **hardcoded placeholder data** — four containers with made-up prices (“Starts at \$1,350”) and dead # links, carried over from the homepage component it was copied from.

The real version — built from live Elasticsearch data for the actual depot — **is currently commented out directly above it**. So the page shows fabricated prices and nothing else. Pointing the new component at the existing `relatedProducts` data is mostly deletion; I can do it on request.

2 · Two controls promise things they don’t do **NEEDS A DECISION**

- **“Save Quote”** has no handler, and the line under it reads *“Price locked for 48 hrs when you save this quote”* — a claim nothing currently backs. Either wire it or drop the line.
- **Payment Option 1** links to `?page_id=288960`, which **301s to the homepage**. Every `?page_id=` on the live site does. Real pages exist, e.g. `/rent-to-own-containers` — tell me which and it is one line.
- **“Ideal for:”** is still six grey placeholder squares.

3 · Carried over from earlier work **STILL OPEN**

- **ADMIN_SESSION_SECRET must be set in Vercel** for preview and production. Without it nobody can reach the admin outside localhost; with it, the five allowlisted accounts can.
- **The product feeds take ~3 minutes per request.** The catalogue array exceeds the framework’s 2 MB cache ceiling, so the cache write is silently dropped and every request rebuilds. Google Merchant’s scheduled fetch will time out. Needs an architectural choice — a slimmer cached projection, pre-generation to object storage, or a custom cache handler.
- **Agent quote requests reach Redis, not sales.** Visible at `/admin/quote-requests`, but `deliverQuoteRequest()` is still a stub.

One note on scope. The previous commit (blogs and AI chat) landed Tuesday 18 August, the day before this window opens, so it is not counted here — though the chat history work in this report builds directly on it.